

Chapter 3: The Harappan Civilization

Textbook Exercise Solutions & Answers



1. Answer in one sentence:

Q1.) How did the civilization get the name Harappa?

Archaeological excavation first began in 1921 CE at Harappa in Punjab on the banks of the river Ravi. Because this was the first site discovered, the entire civilization came to be known as the Harappan civilization.

Q2.) What patterns are seen on the Harappan pots?

The Harappan pots are made of red terracotta featuring patterns and designs painted in black, which include fish scales, interlocking circles, and pipal leaves.

Q3.) What cloth did the Harappan traders supply to Egypt?

The Harappan traders supplied fine muslin cloth to Egypt.

2. What will you do when you visit an ancient site to obtain more information about it, to conserve it, etc.?

1. Collect authentic historical brochures, guidebooks, and speak with official archaeologists or registered site guides.
2. Maintain strict cleanliness and not touch or deface fragile ruins, sculptures, or ancient walls.
3. Follow all safety guidelines and conservation rules established by the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI).
4. Spread awareness among fellow visitors regarding the historic importance and preservation of our heritage.

3. Draw a picture of the Great Bath at Mohen-jo-daro / Describe its architectural features:

1. A spacious public bath was excavated at Mohen-jo-daro.
2. The tank within the Great Bath measured approximately 12 metres in length, 7 metres in width, and about 2.5 metres in depth.
3. The inner lining was built with high-quality baked bricks coated with natural tar to prevent water seepage.
4. Steps were built on both sides leading down into the pool.
5. There were well-planned arrangements for regular draining, cleaning, and refilling of freshwater.

4. In the following chart, fill in the details regarding human life during the Harappan period:

Major Crops	Clothes	Ornaments
• Wheat • Barley • Ragi • Sesame • Cotton	• Knee-length lower garments worn by both men and women. • An upper garment / cloak draped over the left shoulder, often adorned with trefoil patterns.	• Multi-strand necklaces, rings, and bangles made of gold, copper, bronze, and precious stones. • Beads made from agate, carnelian, and shells.

5. Answer in one word and frame similar questions. Write their answers:

Q1.) What stone was used to make the Harappan seals?

Answer: Steatite.

Q2.) (*Framed Question*) Which animal is most frequently depicted on Harappan seals?

Answer: Bull (Unicorn / Humpless Bull).

Q3.) (*Framed Question*) What metal was unknown to the Harappan civilization?

Answer: Iron.